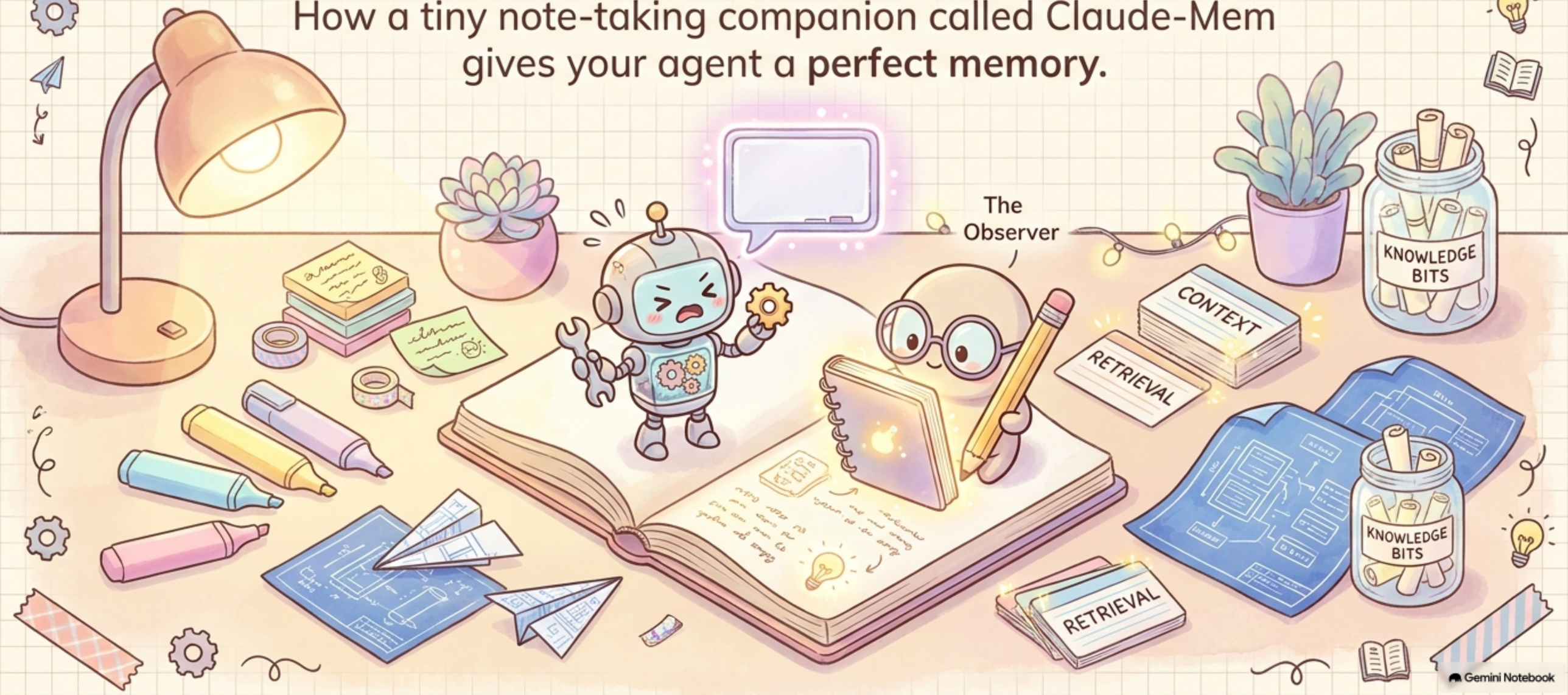
The Hacker’s Field Guide to AI Memory

How a tiny note-taking companion called Claude-Mem gives your agent a **perfect memory.**



Gemini Notebook

Two agents working together: one does the work, one remembers it.

THE BUILDER

1

2

THE OBSERVER

Claude-Mem is a second agent that sits next to your main AI. It watches everything your agent does, writes down the parts worth remembering, and hands those notes back tomorrow so your agent wakes up already knowing what happened yesterday.

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Every morning, your brilliant agent arrives with total amnesia.

Time

Every session starts cold. The first twenty minutes are burned just rediscovering things the agent already knew yesterday.

Money

Rediscovery means re-reading identical files over and over. You pay for the agent to re-learn its own history.

Lost Decisions

The reasoning disappears. "Why did we do it this way?" The answer existed, but nobody wrote it down.

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Life before the Observer versus life after.

Amnesia Morning

The Blank Slate

- **Action:** Re-reads all files, re-asks answered questions, re-tries failed ideas.
- **Result:** Slow momentum, wasted budget, forgotten reasoning.

Warm Boot Morning

Instant Context

- **Action:** Receives a neat timeline of yesterday's insights the moment it wakes up.
- **Result:** Immediate progress, zero wasted tokens, perfect historical continuity.

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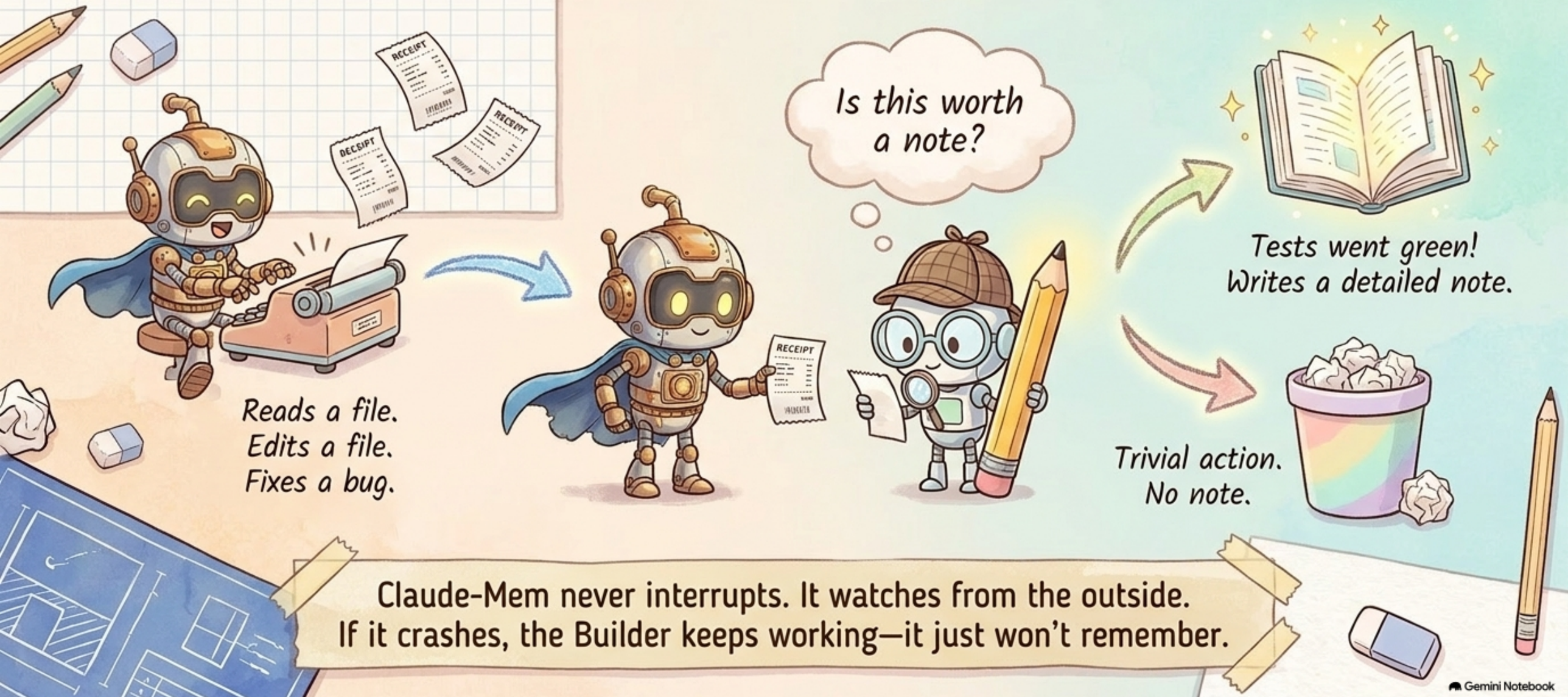
Every action creates a receipt. The Observer decides what matters.



Claude-Mem never interrupts. It watches from the outside.
If it crashes, the Builder keeps working—it just won't remember.

Gemini Notebook

Inside the glowing notebook: the anatomy of a perfect memory.

Title:
The one line that decides if you care

Subtitle:
The immediate context

Facts:
Single-sentence truths

Timestamp:
Powers the timeline

Category:
Bugfix, Feature, Decision

Narrative:
The story of what happened

Tags:
Reusable concepts: #gotcha, #trade-off

Files: Where to jump next.

Refactoring the Payment Gateway for Scalability

Moving from monolithic to microservices architecture - Initial thoughts.

Oct 26, 2023
10:45 AM

Decision

Fact 1: The current gateway handles 100 transactions/sec.

Fact 2: Projected peak load for Black Friday is 5000 transactions/sec.

Fact 3: Stripe API v3 is now supported.

Narrative: After reviewing the performance metrics and the product roadmap, we've decided that a complete refactor is necessary. The monolithic structure is becoming a bottleneck. We explored several microservice approaches and identified the main components for extraction. The team agrees that the initial investment in time will pay off significantly in the long run.

#gotcha
#trade-off
#scalability
#refactor

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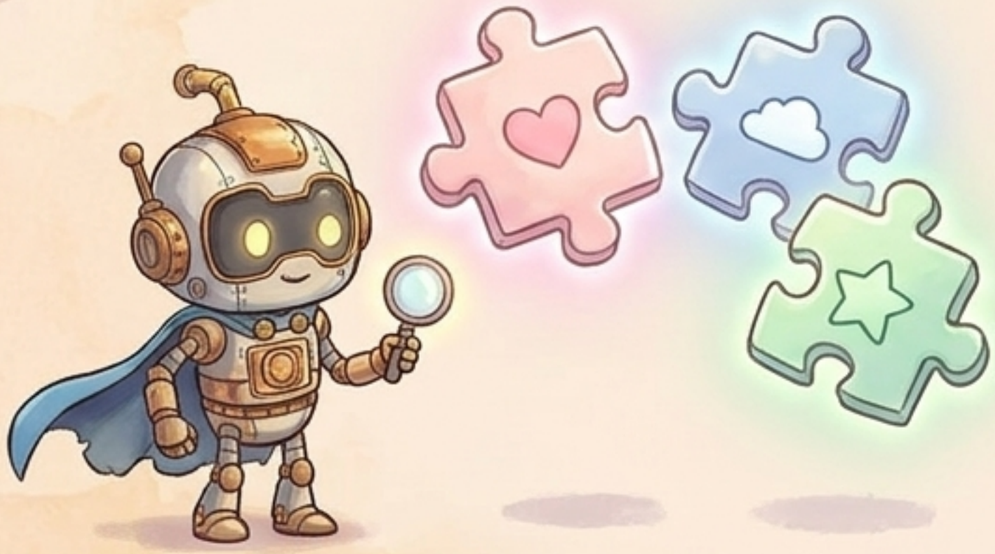
Facts are for skimming. The narrative is for understanding.

The Facts



Three **single-sentence bullet points**.
Each is a standalone, true statement that makes sense with zero surrounding context. context. They are perfectly shaped to be found by search and dropped into totally new conversations.

The Narrative

A **short paragraph telling the story**.
What was happening, what was tried, what was learned, and why it matters.
For when the Builder needs the full picture.

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Retrieving memories the cheap way: titles first, details on demand.

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The Observer's job description is completely swappable.

Code Mode
Watches files and terminals.
Categories: Bugfix, Feature, Refactor.

Email Investigation Mode
Watches inboxes and chat logs.
Categories: Evidence, Anomaly, Entity

Study Partner Mode
Watches transcripts and lectures.
Categories: Concept, Decision, Deadline

Swap a simple config file called a Mode, and the same watchful machinery takes perfectly structured notes on an entirely different domain.

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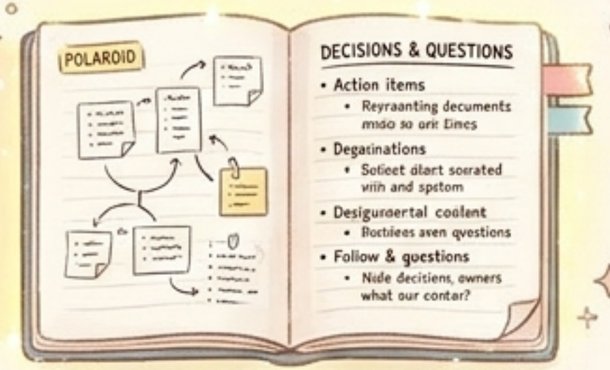
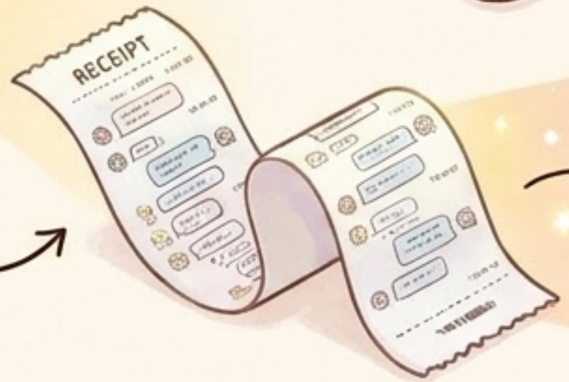
Any data in, perfectly structured patterns out.

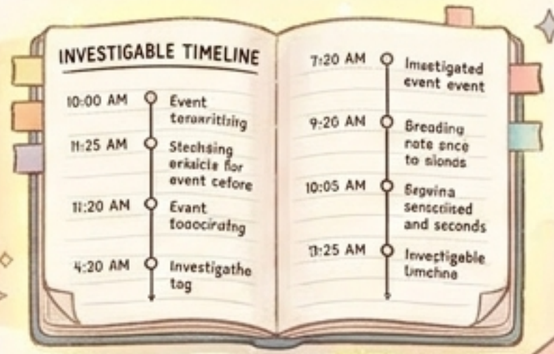
Feed in a photo; the Observer extracts design decisions and open questions.



Feed in a meeting recording; the Observer isolates decisions, owners, and deadlines.

Feed in a Slack dump; the Observer builds an investigable timeline of events.





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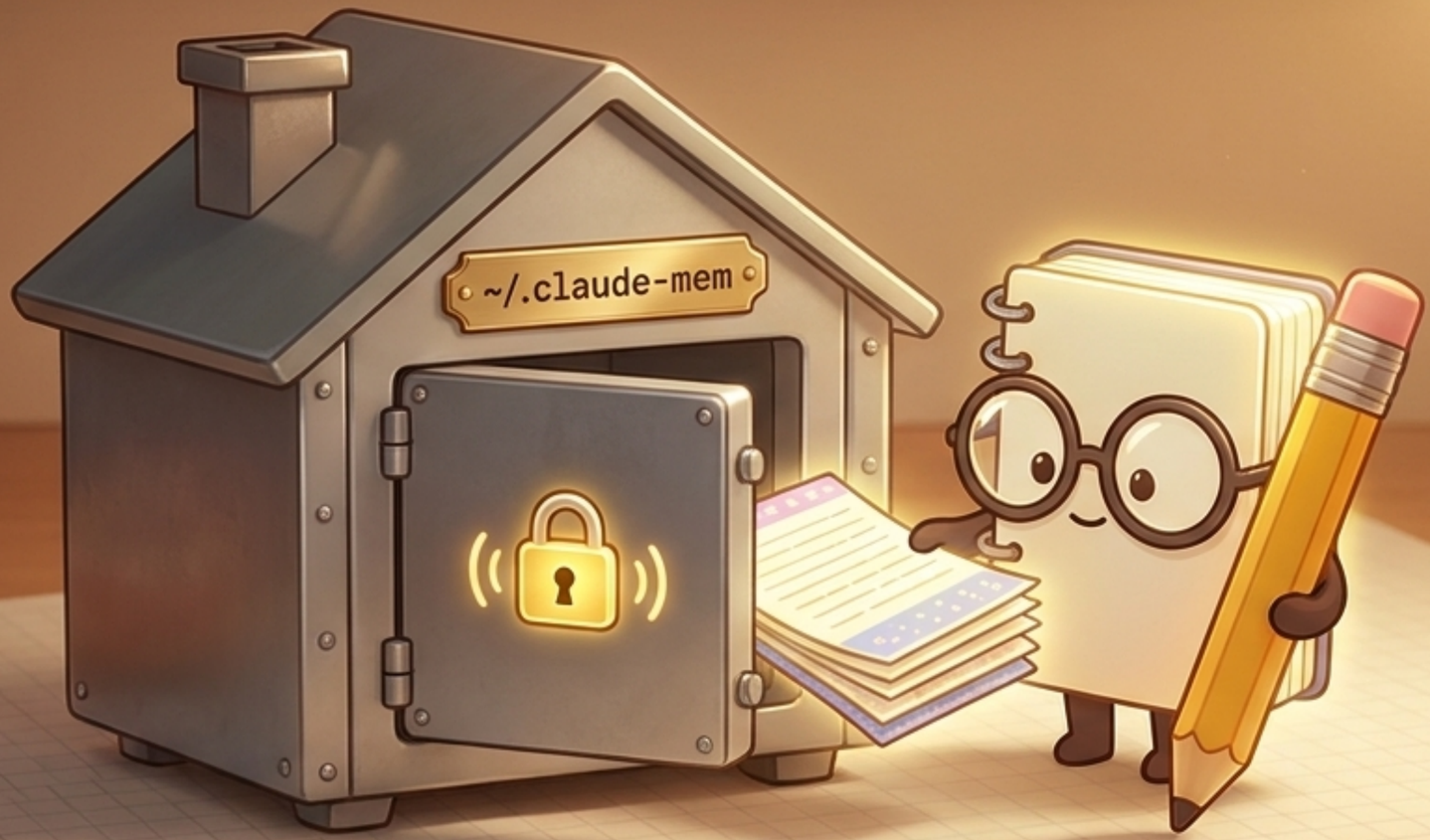
A private sanctuary on your own machine.



Every note and search index lives in a local database in your home folder. Nothing leaves your machine except the calls to the AI model doing the observing. You, the human, get a beautiful local web viewer to watch your memories land in real time as your agent works.

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Small, powerful blocks to build the future on.

Timeline

A time-ordered stream of structured notes. Anchor anywhere and read the surrounding history.

Search

Semantic and keyword search across all notes, filterable by project and category.

Real-Time Hooks

Notes land while the agent works. A pattern appears → a custom trigger fires instantly.

Skills

CLI-shaped helpers (search, timeline report, build knowledge base) ready to be wrapped in your own UI or chat bot.

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$1,000

The $1,000 Memory Prize Quest.

Build an agentic tool that actually remembers. Sponsored by Claude-Mem rrropers, judged separately from overall prizes.

Warm Boot
(Instant context)

Build on the Timeline
(New retrieval layers)

Face for Skills
(UI/UX wrappers)

Ingest Anything
(Custom modes for wild data)

Fire on Sight
(Reactive event hooks)

Speed Play
(Cut tokens and wall-clock time)

Golden Rule: Extra points for something a human would actually use.

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Seed your agent's memory in five minutes.

Step 1: The Spell

Install the magic.

Step 2: The Seed

Start a coding session.
Do some work.
The Observer instantly begins taking background notes.

Step 3: The Magic

Open a second session in the same project.

Watch the agent wake up warm, reading the timeline of what you just finished.

Every hacker gets 30 days of Pro free.
Use the key: FASTHACK30.
Find the map at github.com/thedotmack/claude-mem

Gemini Notebook

The whole field guide on one card.

The Core: A memory layer for AI agents.

The Engine: A second “observer” agent watches every tool use and decides what to note.

The Note: Title + Facts + Narrative + Category + Tags + Files.

The Retrieval: Titles first (cheap), details by ID, semantic search for the rest.

The Modes: Swap job descriptions to observe code, emails, photos, or transcripts.

The Prize: $1,000 for building an agentic tool that remembers.

AI agents are about to do the world’s work.
It’s time they remembered it.

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